

What it was like being a kid in the early 1970's – Metallicman

 metallicman.com/laoban4site/what-it-was-like-being-a-kid-in-the-early-1970s

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This is a walk down “memory lane” as I relate what it was like growing up as a young boy in the early 1970’s. I was in my early teenage years. I went to school, watched a lot of television, and played with my friends. Enjoy...

Introduction

As strange as it seems, there is very little on the internet about what it was like growing up in the 1960’s and 1970’s. It’s almost as if it was scrubbed from existence. In it’s place we now have the Obama narrative of a racist nation and terrible injustices. That narrative has nothing to do with reality. It is a scripted lie intended to manipulate people into believing something that just isn’t true.

Here, in my own little way, I would like to relate some stories of what it was like for me growing up as a kid. For “shits and giggles” I have chosen the year of 1971. It was the last year that I had as a kid before I had to go out and work at 14 in the coal mines.

This narrative takes place in Western Pennsylvania. We lived in a small town about a two hour drive from Pittsburgh. It was a hilly and tree shaded world, with railroad spur lines that snaked in and out of the hills and crossed over viaducts and into tunnels. I well knew those lines as I would often walk along them with my friends on hikes and adventures.



The Allegheny mountains are very beautiful. I miss the beauty of them in the fall, and the joys of canoeing on the river and fishing in the streams.

Visiting my Aunties

Many weekends my parents would drive into Pittsburgh to visit my relatives. Both were from Pittsburgh, though from different areas. We would take turns visiting the families. In the morning we would visit my father's family, and in the afternoon we would visit my mother's family.



A evening scene from Polish Hill. Polish Hill is a suburb of Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. It is a community that was founded by Polish immigrants that went to Pittsburgh to find work in the Steel Mills there.

Often times, there would be other relatives that would come and say hi. I would see my grandparent's brothers and sisters, my great aunts and uncles, if you will. And I might be persuaded to go with them to their homes. For some reason, the homes always smelled like bacon and cabbage.

There was always a pot of coffee on the stove. If it was cold they would either reheat it or make a fresh pot. The coffee pot was a percolator design. The water would start to boil and would be forced up through a metal straw into a container that held coffee grounds. You could control how strong the coffee was by the amount of ground in the upper container and how long you brewed the coffee. There was this glass bubble on the top of the coffee pot that you could watch to tell if the coffee was ready or not.



This is a very common way of making coffee in the 1960's and the 1970's. Every family seemingly had a percolator. This particular picture is very similar to the one that we used at home.

They would almost invariably offer me a cup of coffee and a bowl of what ever is cooking on the stove. There was something always cooking. Sometimes it was spaghetti sauce, sometimes it was chili. Sometimes it was “pigs in a blanket” (pork wrapped up in cabbage). Sometimes it was chicken soup. I could always eat my fill when I visited my aunties.

Of course, every single relative had this painting of “the last supper” on the wall in the kitchen / dining room.



During my childhood every family had a painting of the Last Supper on their wall. My relatives all had it hanging in the kitchen, but many of my friends had it in the living rooms or the dining room instead.

Everyone also pretty much listened to the same radio station as well. Each kitchen had this little plastic radio (of vintage electronic tubes) that was perpetually tuned to the AM radio station KDKA. Popular Music would often be heard while we were visiting.

Pop Songs

While I was pretty much listening to Jefro Tull, Traffic and other rock groups, my relatives and classmates enjoyed the popular music of the time. In 1971 we were listening to the following. Notable songs are highlighted in **BOLD**.

Three Dog Night	Joy To The World
Rod Stewart	Maggie May / (Find A) Reason To Believe
Carole King	It's Too Late / I Feel The Earth Move
Osmonds	One Bad Apple
Bee Gees	How Can You Mend A Broken Heart
Raiders	Indian Reservation
Donny Osmond	Go Away Little Girl
John Denver	Take Me Home, Country Roads

Temptations	Just My Imagination (Running Away With Me)
Dawn	Knock Three Times
Janis Joplin	Me And Bobby McGee
Al Green	Tired Of Being Alone
Honey Cone	Want Ads
Undisputed Truth	Smiling Faces Sometimes
Cornelius Brothers and Sister Rose	Treat Her Like A Lady
Rolling Stones	Brown Sugar
James Taylor	You've Got A Friend
Jean Knight	Mr. Big Stuff
Lee Michaels	Do You Know What I Mean
Joan Baez	The Night They Drove Old Dixie Down
Marvin Gaye	What's Going On
Paul and Linda McCartney	Tom Jones
Bill Withers	Ain't No Sunshine
Five Man Electrical Band	Signs
Tom Jones	She's A Lady
Free Movement	I Found Someone Of My Own
Murray Head and The Trinidad Singers	Jesus Christ Superstar
Jerry Reed	Amos Moses
Grass Roots	Temptation Eyes
Carpenters	Superstar
George Harrison	My Sweet Lord / Isn't It A Pity
Donny Osmond	Sweet And Innocent

Ocean	Put Your Hand In The Hand
Daddy Dewdrop	Chick-A-Boom (Don't Ya Jes' Love It)
Carpenters	For All We Know
Gordon Lightfoot	If You Could Read My Mind
Sammi Smith	Help Me Make It Through The Night
Carpenters	Rainy Days And Mondays
Cher	Gypsy, Tramps And Thieves
Jackson 5	Never Can Say Goodbye
Lynn Anderson	Rose Garden
Hamilton, Joe Frank and Reynolds	Don't Pull Your Love
Ringo Starr	It Don't Come Easy
Nitty Gritty Dirt Band	Mr. Bojangles
Fuzz	I Love You For All Seasons
Dramatics	Whatcha See Is Whatcha Get
Carly Simon	That's The Way I've Always Heard It Should Be
Stevie Wonder	If You Really Love Me
Aretha Franklin	Spanish Harlem
Helen Reddy	I Don't Know How To Love Him
Osmonds	Yo-yo
Aretha Franklin	Bridge Over Troubled Water
Partridge Family	Doesn't Somebody Want To Be Wanted
Tommy James	Draggin' The Line
Ike and Tina Turner	Proud Mary
Chicago	Beginnings / Color My World

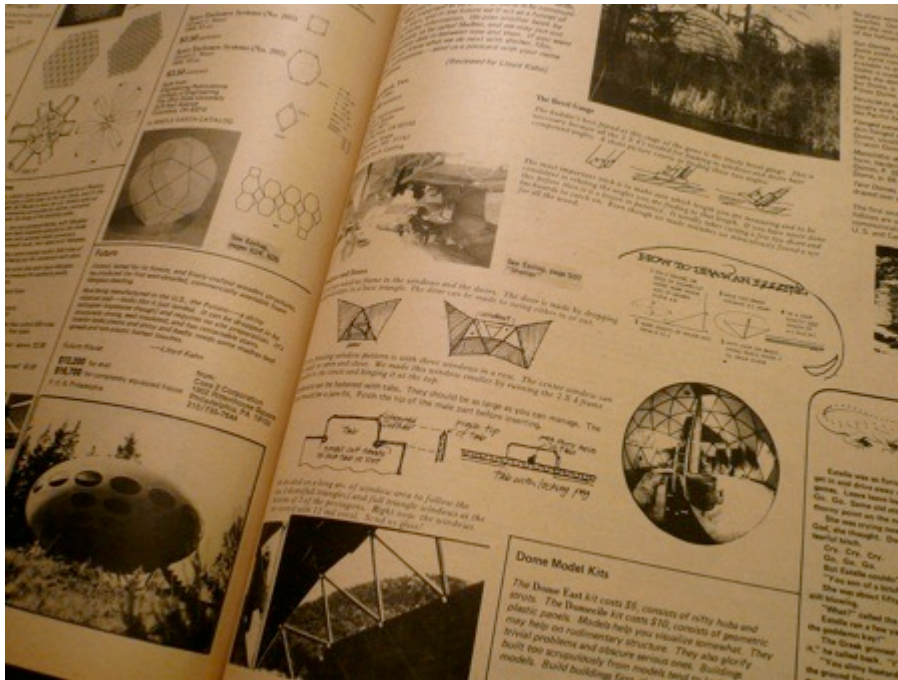
Bells	Stay Awhile
Stampede	Sweet City Woman
Lobo	Me And You And A Dog Named Boo
Paul McCartney	Another Day / Oh Woman, Oh Why
Bread	If
Marvin Gaye	Mercy Mercy Me (The Ecology)
Brewer and Shipley	One Toke Over The Line
8th Day	She's Not Just Another Woman
Freda Payne	Bring The Boys Home
Rare Earth	I Just Want To Celebrate
Delaney and Bonnie and Friends	Never Ending Song Of Love
Freddy Hart	Easy Loving
Three Dog Night	Liar
Honey Cone	Stick-up
Mac and Katie Kissoon	Chirpy Chirpy Cheep Cheep
Andy Williams	Love Story (Where Do I Begin)
Cat Stevens	Wild World
Jerry Reed	When You're Hot, You're Hot
Beginning Of The End	Funky Nassau
Olivia Newton-John	If Not For You
King Floyd	Groove Me
Bobby Goldsboro	Watching Scotty Grow
Matthews' Southern Comfort	Woodstock
Judy Collins	Amazing Grace

Dave Edmunds	I Hear You Knocking
Bee Gees	Lonely Days
Fortunes	Here Comes That Rainy Day Feeling Again
Who	Won't Get Fooled Again
Denise Lasalle	Trapped By A Thing Called Love
Jackson 5	Mama's Pearl
Buoys	Timothy
Partridge Family	I Woke Up In Love This Morning
Isaac Hayes	Theme From "Shaft"
Gladys Knight and The Pips	If I Were Your Woman
Neil Diamond	I Am..I Said
Paul Stookey	Wedding Song (There Is Love)
Wilson Pickett	Don't Knock My Love, Pt. 1
Doors	Love Her Madly
Richie Havens	Here Comes The Sun
Wadsworth Mansion	Sweet Mary
Brenda and The Tabulations	Right On The Tip Of My Tongue
Fifth Dimension	One Less Bell To Answer
Doors	Riders On The Storm
Perry Como	It's Impossible

The song "**Maggie May**" was played to death, and radio stations in central Indiana were still playing that song long into the 1990's. Ugh!

Donny Osmond was terribly popular with my sister and all of her girl friends at the time. Her bedroom was covered in pictures of Donny, and she had her class room textbooks covered in "lunch paper" covers decorated with Donny Osmond related praises.

I first heard “**The night they drove ol’ Dixie down**” when I was riding with my dad in our car. He was involved in technical sales at the time. I would wait in the car and listen to the radio while reading the “[Last Whole Earth Catalog](#)”.



The Last Whole Earth Catalog was a cultural landmark in the 1970's. Kevin Kelly, who was editor-in-chief at Whole Earth was looking at an old Whole Earth Catalog came to the realization that it was a 1970s version of a blog.

Tom Jones was very popular with my mother and the mothers of my friends. He had a kind of sex appeal that really appealed to them.

[Jesus Christ Superstar](#) hit my generation hard. I cannot express how big an impact this movie made at my church and at my school. It seemed like every family had the album. I went and saw the play and it was really moving.

I saw Jerry Reed sing “**Amos Moses**” on “Laugh In” or “Sonny and Cher” I don’t remember which. Both were shows that hosted a mixture of singing, dancing and comedy routines that were quite popular in the day.

The song “**Gypsy, Tramps And Thieves**” was a big hit by Cher. Most people have forgotten about her today. You hear some blurb on the news every now and then, but she was a big thing back in the day. She was super popular.

The song “**Don’t Pull Your Love**” was very popular and got a substantial amount of airtime. You probably couldn’t get by a day without hearing that song at least once. Other heavily air-played songs included “**Mr. Bojangles**”.

Everyone in my school watched the **Partridge Family** . This was a television show about a family that toured schools all over the country and sang at them. Well, they also had a number of hits, as well as a had a following of fans.



How can one talk about the 1960's and 1970's without mentioning the television show The Partridge Family?

The idea and concept of freedom to explore, of adventure and travel was very popular. The ideals of the 1960's were fading away, and the 1970's was a time where people wanted to just go forth and explore the world. The song "**Me And You And A Dog Named Boo**" was representative of this dream.

If there is one iconic song from that year (heck, for that decade), it is "**One Toke Over The Line**". Everyone was listening to it, and everyone related to it. Even my mother who would make the "sigh" and gesture while saying "I guess I'm just one toke over the line...".

This song “**Never Ending Song Of Love**” has fallen into obscurity. Yet it reflected the reality of the small town bars and the culture of friendship and love that was indicative of the era.

The song “**Riders On The Storm**” continued to be popular with me and my classmates long into our college years.

Barbershop

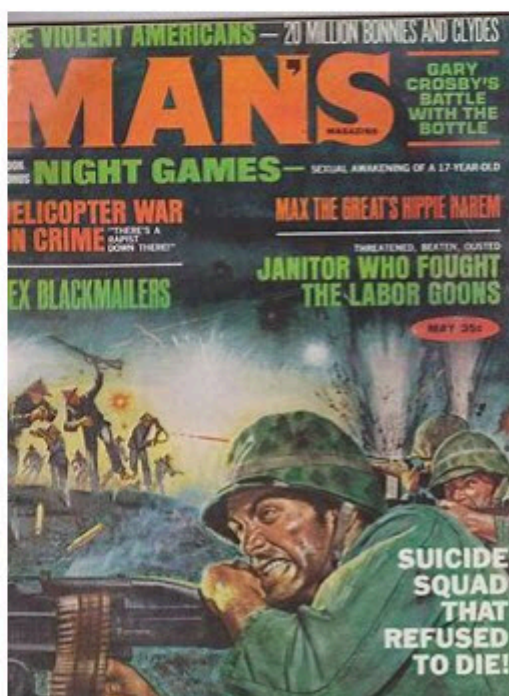
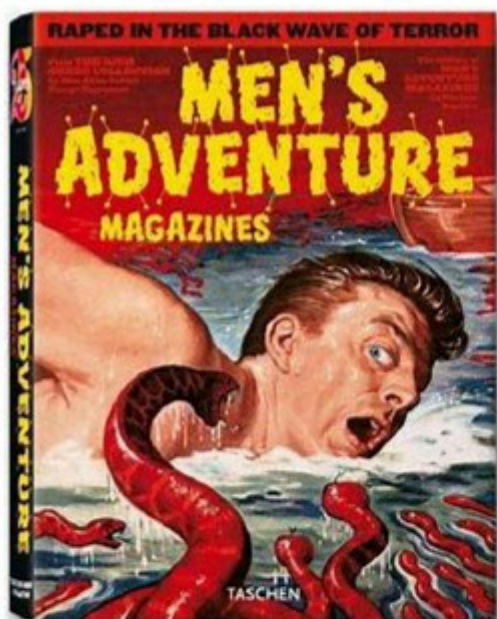
Next to my Father’s parents house was a barbershop. The shop was run by an old man, probably in his 90’s. He lived upstairs above the shop. The barbershop itself was a museum and probably hadn’t changed since the 1940’s.



A barbershop was a place and refuge for men to be men. We could talk about things that interested us , we could talk about sports, girls and life. All barbershops were smoker-friendly places where men could be themselves, free of political correctness and progressive rules.

My father would take me to the barber there and I would get a haircut. I really didn’t want to go because at that time, long hair was fashionable. I would go there and then pout the rest of the day. But, I’ll tell you what, those trips to the barbershop were some of the best memories that I have.

The barbershop was a “men’s only” establishment. On the tables were magazines about hunting, guns and adventure. On the walls were pictures of deer and ducks. There was a full length mirror on the wall that faced two very huge and ornate barber chairs. The barber wore an apron and wore his hair in a style that probably went obsolete in the 1950’s.



When we went to the barbershop we would read the men's adventure magazines that would lie there, as well as the Playboy magazines that would be interspersed with the newspapers and the standing ashtrays.

The chairs were big and comfortable. He would often have friends hang out while he worked. They would sit there smoking cigarettes and watching him cut hair. A small radio would be on and often it would be tuned to a baseball or football game.

The place had it's own kind of unique smell to it. It was a cross between aftershave and old house. The barber lived alone as his wife passed on a decade earlier. He just ran the shop until he died. After he passed on, the place was boarded up and then demolished.

Hiking in the Woods

At that time in my life I spent a lot of time hiking in the woods. I would often ride my bike all over town and up and down the back roads and railroad spur lines. In the Spring the air would be fresh with the smells of lush forest canopy. In the Fall, it would be a time of warm “Indian Summers” with red and yellow leaves that would blow in the light breezes.



I lived in a small town in Pennsylvania. The hills all around us were wooded and access to them was via back roads and rail lines. As a boy, I would spend a lot of time walking on these tracks and exploring the world around me.

I rode a gold Schwinn “banana seat” bike with “high bars” and a “drag strip” (non-tread) rear tire. Every one of my friends owned a bicycle. My sister had one with a white plastic basket in the front. My bike had these long streamers of plastic that plugged into the handles. I eventually tore those things off. But I would put a card (from a deck of cards) and attach it to the bicycle with a wooden clothes pin. That way my bicycle would make some “cool” sounds when I rode fast. It had a huge red circular red reflector on the back,

right under the white “banana seat”. Like the GTO I would later drive when I was in High School, the bicycle was an orange color.



We would all ride bicycles when we grew up. Which is different than kids today. Instead, today their parents drive them from event to event, instead of expecting them to get there on their own. *A 1970s childhood.* (Image [Source](#))

My bike was a personal selection. When my father took me to a store to pick it out, I chose a really simple and rugged model. There were no front or rear brakes on the handlebars. To brake, you would just use the pedals. There also weren't any gears. There was one gear only. It came with a rear view mirror, that soon broke off, and that was about it. My friends all had more complicated bicycles, and over the years, they were perpetually repairing their bikes and trying to fix them. For me, I never had that problem.

Television Shows

At that time the only television channels that we could watch were CBS, NBC, and ABC. We also had “channel 13” which was a government channel. All of our news, and our entertainment came from these three sources. Since we never had the kind of selection that we have today, we didn't find anything wrong with it. It was normal for us.

Network		8:00 PM	8:30 PM	9:00 PM	9:30 PM	10:00 PM	10:30 PM
ABC		The Brady Bunch	The Partridge Family (16/22.6)	Room 222 (28/19.8) (Tied with Cannon)	The Odd Couple	Love, American Style	
CBS	Fall	The Chicago Teddy Bears	O'Hara, U.S. Treasury		The New CBS Friday Night Movies (30/19.5)		
	Winter	O'Hara, U.S. Treasury		The New CBS Friday Night Movies (30/19.5)		The Don Rickles Show	
NBC	Fall	The D.A.	World Premiere Movie				Local
	Winter	Sanford and Son (6/25.2)					

Here is the complete television selection for Friday night viewing in 1971. It is pretty sparse isn't it. This is where all American got their news and found out about the world around them.

As sparse as the selection was, we were perpetually glued to the television set. There was usually a movie a night. They were often a few years old, after being shown in the movie theaters. If the movie wasn't shown in the theaters it would be called a "World Premiere Movie".

Television was rather primitive.

While we did have a color television, we still needed to walk across the room to change the channel. Imagine that! Remote controls were not available until the mid-1970's. On top of it were "[rabbit ears](#)" until we were able to subscribe to cable in the late 1970's. My grandmother had her "rabbit ears" with aluminum foil wrapped around it. She said that it improved her reception. Maybe it did. I don't know, her reception really sucked, so it must have been really, really terrible.

My favorite after-school show was "[The Flintstones](#)". All of my classmates watched it. There were many shows that I watched when I was growing up. It went from the black and white "[Diver Dan](#)" series, to the [Fireball XL-5](#), [Supercar](#), and included such staples as [Gilligans Island](#), and the [Man from U.N.C.L.E.](#)

I would watch the news reluctantly. For me it was pretty boring.

However, I did follow the news about space. You couldn't miss it. Everyone was talking about space, and the moon. That is all you heard about as a child of the 1960's. The television shows also helped to maintain this theme.

As the news that played on the radio concerned our exploration of space and the Vietnam War. Of course I didn't know what was going on. It was a [takeover of the United States government](#) by dark forces embedded deep inside the United States government. When JFK was shot, my father insisted that I watch the television. He kept telling me that this was the most important thing to happen to the United States since the Civil War. He was a lifelong Democrat and he had real concerns that there was more to the story than what the government was saying. Later, after he died and President Trump released the transcripts, it turned out that my father was right after all.

The "Deep State" murdered our President.

"This fucker, johnson should be dug up and pissed on, and torn apart. Every modern ill can be traced to him."

- [sowhat1929](#)

On Sunday we watched Mutual of Omaha's "Wild Kingdom", and "The FBI" (Starring [Efrem Zimbalist Jr](#)) after the Walt Disney hour. If I wasn't watching television, I was building plastic scale models, or experimenting on my Gilbert chemistry (and electrical) sets.

The A. C. Gilbert Company was an American toy company, once one of the largest toy companies in the world. It is best known for introducing the Erector Set to the marketplace. A chemistry set is an educational toy allowing the user (typically a teenager) to perform simple chemistry experiments.

During the Bill Clinton presidency (D) all sales of chemistry, electronics, and mechanical kits were put under investigation as possible routes for "home grown" terroristic activities, and were subsequently suppressed, if not outright banned. Over the Bush years (R), they resurfaced and eked out a small living. However, by 2017 most hobby kit suppliers went out of business. [Ramsey electronics](#), [Heithkit electronics](#) RIP.

At that time in my life, I like the rest of my classmates, watched shows like the Partridge Family and The Brady Bunch. These shows were about "us". It was how we interacted with each other, and our families and our communities. This all began to change when the television media decided to change their programming towards minorities in urban areas. Television began a slow phase away from white families living in suburbia and began to concentrate on poor urban minorities.



The Brady Bunch. The Brady Bunch is an American sitcom created by Sherwood Schwartz that aired from September 26, 1969, to March 8, 1974, on ABC. The series revolves around a large blended family with six children. Considered one of the last of the old-style family sitcoms, the series aired for five seasons and, after its cancellation in 1974, went into syndication in September 1975. While the series was never a critical or ratings success during its original run, it has since become a popular staple in syndication, especially among children and teenaged viewers.

Shows about black people were limited to “[Stanford and Son](#)”, and “[The Jefferson’s](#)”.

“The “rural purge” of American television networks (in particular CBS) was a series of cancellations in the early 1970s of still-popular rural-themed shows with demographically skewed audiences, the majority of which occurred at the end of the 1970–71 television season. In addition to rural themed shows, the purge also eliminated several high rating variety shows that had been on CBS since their beginning of television broadcasting. One of the earliest efforts at channel drift, CBS in particular saw a dramatic change in direction with the shift, moving away from shows with rural themes and toward ones with supposedly more appeal to urban audiences.”

- [Wikipedia](#)

The shows we watched were funnier than what you see on television today. And, maybe, just maybe a little more innocent. “The Bob Newhart Show” was typical. The humor involved day to day situations and NEVER mentioned race (compare that to today), and had a real twisted surrealistic sense of humor. Consider “[Mary Hartman. Mary Hartman](#)”, or “[Green Acres](#)”. You can find out more [here](#).



Iconic characters from the Bob Newhart show that was popular in the 1970s and 1980s. *Hi! I am Larry, and this is my brother Darryl and my other brother Darryl.* (Image [Source.](#))

Ah, you've got to hear about the [three yokel brothers](#) in the (very surrealistic) 80's "The Bob Newhart show". I loved these guys. They might have been the highlight of the show. Heck, they could have had their own show (hint. Hint.)

"...discovering that a witch is buried in the basement of their Vermont inn. They want to find out who she was, but they also want her 300-year-old grave dug up and removed.

The silly-from-next-door tells him he knows some guys who'll do anything for a buck.

Next thing, three goofy-looking, backwoods brothers from the genetically weak side of Vermont show up. "Oh, Lord!" says Bob, getting a whiff. Larry--the only brother who ever talks--hands Bob their card.

"We'll do anything for a buck," it says."

- [Larry, Darryl And Darryl Are `Newhart` Hits](#)

Larry was the spokesman. Darryl and Darryl never spoke except in the classic final episode. No matter how many times Larry met you, he always started off by saying "[Hello. I'm Larry. This is my brother Darryl and this is my other brother Darryl.](#)"

They were quite [good hearted](#), and obviously lived a strange, strange life. Afterall, clubbed weasel was their idea of good eatin'. Larry's totally deadpan delivery of some very bizarre

lines was always a highlight of any Newhart episode. *"We went to the bakery 'cause they were advertising 'bear claws', but it turned out to just be a come-on."*

Ah. Good times. Good times.

Movies and television portrayed westerns (with "white men" taming the wilderness), war adventures (mostly involving world war II fighting the evil Nazi army), space exploration (such as [Lost in Space](#), Star Trek, [Fireball XL-5](#), [Thunderbirds are Go](#) and [Land of the Giants](#)), and [Spy Adventures](#) (against the Soviet Union or against fictional organizations such as T.H.R.U.S.H.).

Scale Models

One of my favorite hobbies was the building of plastic models. These were often of ships, airplanes and military hardware. I made a few models of cars, but my favorites were of military tanks and figurines.

I had a desk in my bedroom. It was an old desk inherited from my father with four drawers. I used a fold-up "card table" chair to sit at it with. On it was a 1940's style desk lamp that my parents must have pulled out of the garbage at some time. I had books on the desk, a "multiband" radio where I could listen to FM radio, and a pencil holder made out of a decorated metal coffee cup tin.

At that desk, I would assemble, build and paint my models. It was an enjoyable pursuit. The desk faced the window in the bedroom, and I would often have the windows open, but the shade drawn down about half way. The shades were in the old 1960's style and were meant to last. They had this kind of "life preserver" style ring hanging on a string that you could pull down to raise or lower the shade.

I needed the fresh air, as the odor from the glue was toxic and would tend to get me all flustered when I used it. I remember once, that my sister was watching her television show and they were really pushing the *Rigley Chewing Gum-gum-gum... Rigley chewing gum-gum-gum* commercial. It must have been running every ten minutes. I was about going out of my mind with the combination of the toxic glue odor and the subliminal programming of the chewing gum. Ugh!



I would build the models and paint them. Then, I would carefully hang them from the ceiling. My room was filled with models of various sizes and shapes.

The airplanes I would hang from the ceiling with string. I would display my collection of tanks and military equipment on shelves alongside my collection of centuries-old bottles. (I was an avid junk collector and was always on the lookout for discarded bottles that I would collect from ancient trash dumps in the nearby forests.)

I collected Tamiya 1/35 scale military hardware models. I had quite a collection of German vehicles and tanks. At that time, the Japanese model maker Tamiya made the best quality models. They had an innovative introduction process that added new model to the collection every few months.



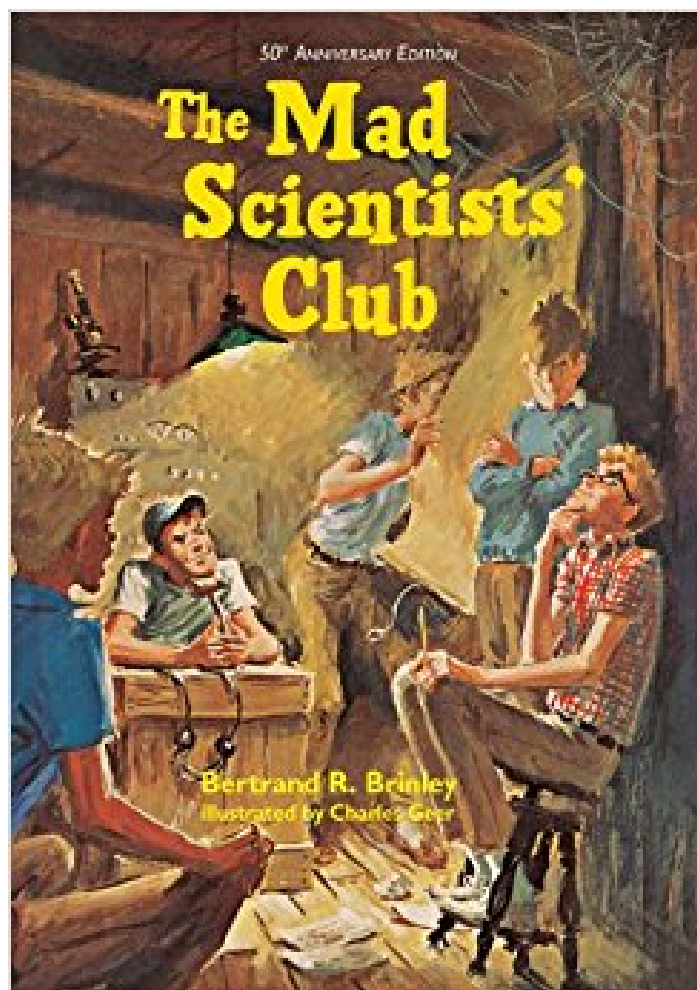
This is a model of the German Tiger I tank. I had numerous models of this massive beast in various scales. I even had one so complete that the interior was all detailed.

Alas, when I graduated from university I discovered that my mother had thrown away all of my models. She didn't want all the clutter in the house. I guess one person's treasure is another person's trash.

Science Fiction

I started reading Science Fiction avidly. With one of the first books being the "Mad Scientist Club".

The Mad Scientist Club is a series of stories (and books) written in the 1960's which fueled the imagination and adventures of us children in the 1970's. (The son of the author has a website. You can visit the website [HERE](#).) These stories inspired me. They inspired my dreams and led me down the path towards technical excellence.



The cover from the first book of "The Mad Scientists Club". This is a classic book for all young children entering their early teens.

The boys in the stories used science to create all sorts of pandemonium and mayhem in their little town. They applied themselves to using science to make devices and gadgets. They played pranks. The books showed how a boy could engineer a device from techniques that they learned in school. They made balloons, talked on ham radios, devised electronics, and they did it all on their very own.

The beauty about all this was that they never asked for help or permission. They took the initiative and did it on their own. They applied themselves.

Indeed, these stories are special. But, don't take it from me. Read what others have to say.

"This is the best kids book ever.

... In a way it saddens me when I re-read it. I don't think our kids today have as much freedom as these did (or my generation). I remember staying out until dark, riding my bike EVERYWHERE, clubhouses on vacant lots...Or maybe it's responsibility. Kids today have freedom but little responsibility. I'm getting off my soapbox now. but this is a cool book and it will make your kids fall in love with science. I imagine the Mythbusters grew up like this- or maybe their dads did!! "

-[Holly](#) commentary on the book. Found at [Goodreads](#).

I am afraid that Holly is correct. American children (and adults) don't have as much freedom as we all used to. (It's our fault, you know.) These books are for kids and inspires them to accomplish things through study and action. These books are not about getting a group together and finding a group consensus. It's not about how to cautiously speak so as not to offend anyone. Nope. It is about getting things done and raising hell in the process.

It's books like these that inspired many of us to study science and engineering. It certainly affected me. It also affected others. I am not the only one who studied about rockets and space...

"This was simply a great childhood book for any inquisitive kid who likes science, haunted houses, dinosaurs, flying machines, etc. I read this book in about seventh or eighth grade and actually a couple of times since. I believe this book helped me on my career to being a rocket scientist but it also gave me many ideas as I was growing up.

Brinley managed to capture the perfect mid-west US town and the guys in the book were great caricatures of fun loving, science minded boys with a bit of good natured mischief up their sleeves. Then Brinley took this setting and boys and produced a series of wonderful stories capturing so many things that so many boys growing up find so intriguing.

I bought a copy recently for a nephew and he was enraptured by it. The follow-ups while good never really reached the level of this first book but were fun in their own right. It will always hold a special memory of growing up back in the '60s."

-[Robert](#) commentary on the book. Found at [Goodreads](#).

He's right you know. The stories certainly inspired me.

I like to think that there is inspiration in stories where you find adventure, freedom and independence. These are things that are absolutely missing in the modern realm of politically correct stories. Which, by the way, is a very important point. By following a

“Politically Correct” narrative, you retard the growth of young boys. To paraphrase [Clint Eastwood](#), you turn men into pussies.

“We live in more of a pussy generation now, where everybody's become used to saying, “Well, how do we handle it psychologically?” In those days, you just punched the bully back and duked it out. Even if the guy was older and could push you around, at least you were respected for fighting back, and you'd be left alone from then on.”

- [Clint Eastwood](#)

A parent has a responsibly to PREPARE their children to venture out and grow. They need to go forth and carve a life out of the wilderness. But that is not what is happening today. Instead we have children that never leave the nest. Young men, in the United States, live at home until they are in their 30's. Instead of investing their time in building, workings, making, and creating, they are too busy looking at cat videos on the Internet while they post their latest latté on Facebook. Boys must be taught to aspire to be Men, not to be a woman's version of a *sensitive* man.

Pussies.

No amount of tattoos, unique hair or beard, or cool urban clothing style is going to make you into a Man. It comes from within. Education alone won't do it. Money and wealth won't do it. Polite conversation won't do it. It comes from inside. It comes from deep down inside. It comes from a place that says “you can, and must do what you need to do”. You don't ask for permission, or consensus. You go out and carve your life out. Alone.

By clutching on to your children like over protective mothers, the children don't grow up. Physically they might age, but the brain and the emotions are still that of a young child. How else can you explain the SWJ mentality that demands a protective overseer? Which is what they want, you know. They demand to be coddled and taken care of by a big parental government [Bernie Sanders style](#). Because, that is all that they know. They don't know how to be independent. We don't teach that anymore.

These books break us out of that mold...

“A gem. Almost unknown; but one of the most hilarious and memorable laugh-out-loud books you could ask for. It's never mentioned by anyone; it's never recommended, placed on book lists or chosen by reading-groups. This just might be because it's a series of books, which represents a 'philosophy-of-parenting', which has fallen out of favor. That's my suspicion, anyway.

I mean, just think about it. These stories are about kids who are unmonitored; who are allowed to just go off on summer afternoons and hang out on their own; and do whatever they want.... because they are trusted by their folks. Today, this is the last thing parents want to hear. No one in today's control-freak, micro-managing America wants to imagine that children can be trusted like this.

Books for very young children ('Little Prince' or 'Giving Tree') are in abundance on Goodreads. They're sweet and harmless. There's also a new genre called 'YA' ('young adult'). But guess what? They're all very sanitary, careful, cautious, and timid. Antiseptic. Content-supervised and Content-controlled. They always instruct youngsters on the 'correct' thing to do, the 'sensitive' thing to do, the 'courteous' thing to do...blah blah blah.

'Mad Scientists' is different. Instead of caution, the author praises problem-solving, solidarity, daring, and initiative. It's a book written for kids illustrating how NOT to follow the rules. It's a book, which shows that rules are made to be flouted.

These stories are from a time when today's endless complexities and anxieties just weren't around. It's a book that deals with kids just... having fun. I say, there need to be a LOT MORE books like this.

The gang of boys in Brinley's tales are pre-teens; somewhere between 11 and 14. This is a strange interval in a boy's matriculation, when they need to figure out a lot of things about life (and it's also a time when adults have the least relevant advice to offer). This is the space Brinley plays in: the theme of personal responsibility.

Teens NEED to create a few genuine catastrophes in order to learn the weight of 'cause' vs 'effect'. 'Intention' vs 'outcome'. 'Actions' vs 'harm'. They need to learn the ins-and-outs of friendship and loyalty and paying-one's-dues.

The 'Mad Scientists Club' (this is the name carved on their clubhouse door) demonstrate these themes grandly. These young scamps are precisely in that age where you learn how to make a mess and how you clean it up afterwards. By yourself!

The crazy scenarios which afflict these affable 'troublemakers' reminds us--should remind everyone-- that this process can be fun. Making mistakes and learning from them. The best way --nay, the ONLY way--to shape character.

Far cry from today, huh? Yeah. Today, we don't let kids have 'secret clubs', 'hideouts', codewords, or 'mysterious friends'. We don't let them play with equipment or tools. They must not 'wreck' anything of ours. They're certainly not allowed to 'gallivant all over creation' (love that phrase).

Modern parents are rule-mongers and control freaks. When our kids want to play, we take them to 'Sesame Place' and we monitor their nutrition and we deck them in flashing sneakers and put them in helmets and on leashes. We place them in soccer, swim class, softball, karate, dance, gymnastics.

The result? Modern kids have no idea what real 'freedom' means. We never give it to them. They turn out to be vegetables.

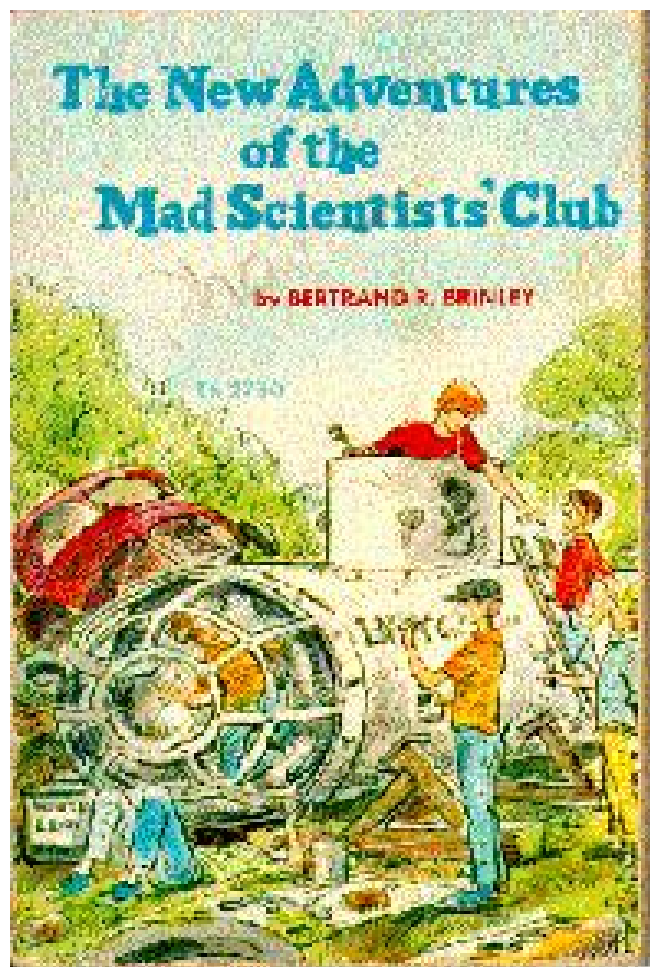
But Brinley's kids show the other way it can be done. This boy's club makes their own fun. They don't 'ask for permission' to do stuff--they just do it! They embrace wildness, zaniness, and unpredictability. The outcome? Well, they aren't brought up on charges from the Department of Homeland Security, for the trouble they cause. That's for sure. This is a part of small town-Americana we've let slip away.

Just one example: in one of the adventures undertaken by the Mad Scientists, they build their own hot-air balloon (using scraps from a local junkyard) and they enter it in the town's annual homemade hot-air balloon race. With no adult supervision at all. Once aloft, (!!) they engaged in an air-battle with their arch-foes and fire potato-cannons and slingshots back'n'forth in mid-air. Finally, they manage to send the enemy gang's balloon into the lake! Can you stand it? I can't friggin' stand it, can you?

This book reminds us that children used to be perfectly capable of taking care of themselves if we let them...if we weren't all scared out of our wits by molesters and semi-automatic weapons and drugs and porn and stalkers and computers, we'd still remember the kind of America found in this hilarious read. It's to our shame that we can't."

-[Feliks](#) commentary on the book. Found at [Goodreads](#).

Let me simply posit this; to all those men (not to intentionally exclude women, but I am a man addressing myself to other men) who have made something of their life. Maybe you are a barber, a motorcycle mechanic, a car salesman, or a cook, isn't it true? To make it in this world, you need to stretch your neck out. You need to take risks, bend the rules a little. You need to apply yourself.



The cover to the book "The New Adventures of the Mad Scientist Club". This is the sequel to the first book. It is also good, though personally, I really prefer the first book overall.

Those times when life got tough, did you go and get permission? Did you go and ask for consensus? Did you politely ask for others opinions, or did you just go out and do whatever it took to achieve your goals? Was it easy? Nope, I'll wager that it was hard, or at least uncomfortable. You might have to make sacrifices. Right? Right???

Part of the need to accomplish these tasks were goals. These goals were like this golden orb that lay there, just out of reach that you needed to obtain. You would work towards those goals. You would keep those goals in mind while you fought and persevered. A goal might be a car. A goal might be the love of your life.

A man is nothing without a goal.

A goal might be something more honorable and important, like saving the world. As everyone can't be an evil villain like George Soros. Or, a wealthy trillionaire like Bill Gates. Someone needs to wear the mask of a hero...

The Idols

My bedroom was decorated as any boy of my my age would have. It was festooned with models and collections of brick-a-bract and posters on the wall. I had a poster of [Farah Fawcett](#) on my wall. She was smiling with this amazing smile, and her huge hair. We all had a crush on her. That as well as [Loni Anderson](#) and [Rachael Welch](#) . Look at her!

How can you not smile?



Farah Fawcett was every 1970s boy's dream. Just about everyone had a poster of her on our wall or doors in our bedrooms. Farah Fawcett was every boys' dream. (Image [Source](#).)

I had numerous posters on my wall. One was the mandatory [“black light” poster](#) on velvet. (It glowed under UV light.) One was a picture of [Richie Blackmore](#) ([Deep Purple](#)) performing a guitar solo. (I had super imposed a [F-14](#) on it for combined imagery. After all, space and high-performance aircraft and rock n' roll was my dream.) One was a [Roger Dean poster](#) (anyone remember the group [“Yes”](#)?).



Raquel Welch was another popular actress that graced the bedrooms of many a boy during the 1960s and 1970s.
([Image Source.](#))

I became a fan of Loni Anderson in her role in the television sitcom “WKRP in Cincinnati”. I think many of my friends did as well. We loved her and watching her on the show was always a highlight. That and the clueless manager who ran the office.



Loni Anderson played the role of the attractive secretary in the American sitcom "WKRP in Cincinnati".

Telephones

There were no cell phones; indeed most phones hung on the wall, and fully 50% of them had dials instead of push buttons. Our home had two phones. One was an old Bakelite black phone from the 1920's hidden away in the basement. I loved the feeling of it. There was a weight to it that you just couldn't get during the 1970's. We also had a "main" phone in the kitchen. It had an extra-long cord. My sister was always "hogging it up". So one year

they bought her a phone for her room. She still spent most of her time on the phone, it's just that she wasn't talking in the kitchen all day.



Sunday mornings were very much the same during the 1960s and 1970s. This included the children in PJ's, the coffee, and the pets. Sunday mornings were stereotypical. (Image [Source](#).)

In the house we wore “house clothes” also known as PJ's, with a robe. Mother would make sure that there was always a pot of coffee brewing, and us kids would always fight over who would get to read the comics section of the paper first. Of course, our dogs and cats merrily participated in the morning ritual. Picture above is not the ideal, it was the actual.

Global Cooling and the “Green Movement”

1970s



*Global Ecology: Readings toward
a Rational Strategy for Man
by Reid Bryson (1971)*

**“The continued rapid cooling of
the earth since World War II
is in accord with the increase
in global air pollution
associated with industrialization,
mechanisation, urbanisation
and exploding population.”**



We were terrified of the global cooling. Thousands of experts were constantly informing us of the up coming global ice age that would turn Florida into a Siberian wasteland.

In our schools we would go on field trips to clean up the environment. We would go on “collection drives” to collect money for our environment, and we ended up with absolute bushels of money. (Don’t know where it all went, though...) We attended classes on the environment and school rallies to lecture us on the up-coming [global cooling](#) that would soon turn the world into a snow cone.

We were terrified!

Every cold day was a sign that the world was plunging into another great ice age. Magazines, the media, and the news all had stories about the coming cold period and the need to raise taxes to save our environment. Experts were paraded on television to teach us the need to raise taxes, and fund more research.



Here's a selection of some covers from Time Magazine during the 1970's. The big concern was about "global cooling" and how that taxes had to be increased to fund studies so as to stop it.

The "[Love Canal](#)" fiasco acted as a terrible "kick start" to the "environmental movement". Americans began to wake up that we had been really abusing our environment. As such, immediate action had to be taken. And thus the government took action in the only way that it knew how...

- It set up the EPA, and...
- Raised taxes.

Which was the entire purpose of the decade long propaganda push; To [1] increase the size and scope of the government, and [2] to raise more taxes to go to Washington D.C..

"What's it mean, anyway? Do 97% of #Scientists agree that the climate is changing? Actually, everyone agrees with that – that the Earth's climate changes over time is why we had an ice age. Well, we had an ice age a long time ago. We did not have one after the #Science people promised an ice age in the 1970s. But shhhh! We're not supposed to mention that."

Want to know what the proposed solution for the '70s ice age that never arrived was? Give the liberal elite more money and power. Overpopulation was another big crisis in the '70s too. It never arrived either. The solution to that was to give the liberal elite more money and power. And when they were warning us about acid rain destroying us in the '80s? The solution to that crisis was also to give the liberal elite more money and power. The ozone hole? Yep, more of our money and power to the liberal elite. Back in the 1990s, the Al Gores of the world were warning us that we had just 10 years left to save the Earth unless ... wait for it ... we gave the liberal elite more money and power.

Sense some themes?

Each of these crises all had two things in common. Thing One was that none of these doomsdays ever produced the promised doom. Thing Two was that each was a demand to

give the liberal elite more money and power.”

– [Kurt Schlichter](#)

Family Meals

One of the things that I have come to appreciate the most was the family meal that we had when I was growing up as a child. During my early childhood we would hold formal “sit down” meals in the Dining Room. Us children each had our own roles / chores in regards to this. On Sunday we would have the largest and most elaborate meals. Mealtime was the opportunity when we could all talk about our day, our hopes and dreams, and things that interested us.

At the time, I didn’t realize how important it was.

Then, during the 1970’s everything changed. Both of my parents had to work. (You can thank the American Federal Reserve for the decline in the value of the dollar that necessitated the breakup of our families.) A formal family meal was replaced with “help yourself” fix your own meals, out of a pot on the stove, or “make yourself a snack” out of the refrigerator. We would then scrounge something up, and eat it alone watching television.

Communication was via notes on the refrigerator.

Now that I am much older, I can see clearly the value of a family meal as well as a community meal. As such, I now dictatorially enforce an observance of this tradition within my own home.



The Importance of a Family Meal Together

There is nothing more important and satisfying than spending time together with friends and family and eating a meal together. It is a time of friendship, familial bonding and relaxation. Here we discuss what I have learned from my childhood and how I apply it today in my life.

Fishing with my Father

I will conclude with this little narrative of my experiences in 1971 talking about my father. He used to spend the time and take me and my siblings out to the river to fish. He had a couple of rods and a tackle box that he inherited from his (favorite) uncle. Using it, he taught me how to fish, and how to gut and clean the fish.

While it is a great memory of mine, the best part, and the part that remember most clearly is how he would drive out to the lake or stream, and we would then troop down to the area

to fish. He was always on the lookout for isolated and secluded areas to fish in. He yearned for the “perfect spot”. One with deep water and plenty of overhanging limbs and trees that fish can hide in.

Oh, I would go fishing with my friends. They had an assortment of remote cabins, canoes and secret places that always provided us a great deal of pleasure. But, it was the times with my father that mattered the most to me. My friends were always up to something.

[via GIPHY](#)

I once had a friend who placed plastic sheeting on his garage floor and dumped a dump truck full of soil on it. He, at age 13, had constructed a worm farm, and he somehow had this crazy idea that he would get “filthy rich” selling worms to the local bait and tackle shops. He did actually manage to sell some. I think he might have made \$5 or so. Eventually, he gave up the idea and paid some one to haul the dirt away. His dream of instant millions went bust.

I never became an expert at fishing. I was, I guess you could say, an enthusiastic hobbyist. For me, the time with my father fishing were some of the best moments of my life, and moments that I will treasure until I too, will die.

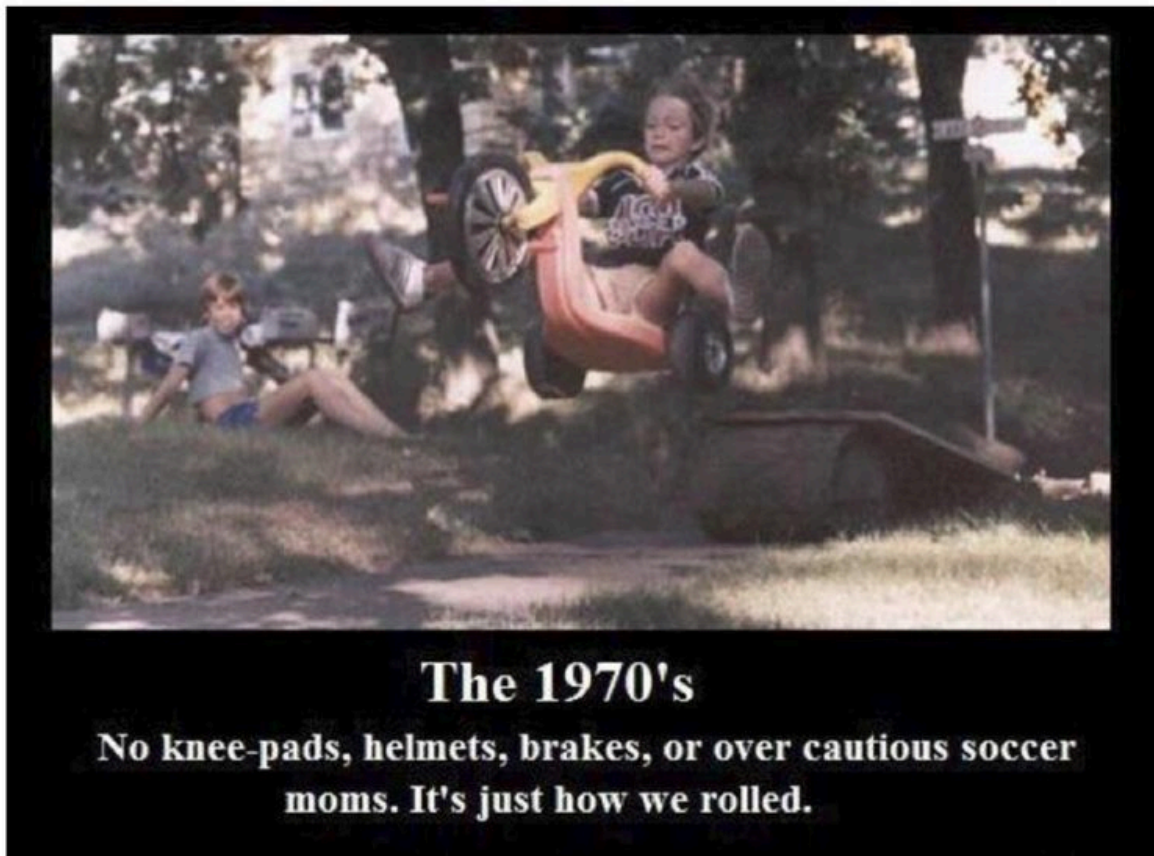
Conclusion

This was just a little narrative that I wrote about what it was like for me in 1971. It’s a far cry from the United States today. The USA today saddens me. Every time I read the news, I get either depressed or angered. There’s not really too much that I can do about the slide into open civil strife that America is plunging towards, all that I can do is take care of myself and think good thoughts.

This includes what it was like growing up as a boy.

Take Aways

- Global Cooling was a sham designed to trick Americans into permitting a larger government and giving away more of their money.
- There were only four television channels that we American had access to in the early 1970’s.
- The family meal is the most important part of having a family. It is important to nurture and cultivate relationships.
- Television shows used to focus on American culture instead of bastardized urban minority culture.
- My favorite memories of my father was when we were fishing together.



This is how we rolled. We were allowed to experience life in all it's ugly and beautiful glory. Life is about living.

Posted On Free Republic

This article was posted on Free Republic in the chat section and collected a number of interesting comments. Many of which, I really do need to write about. Particularly what it was like for my sisters at that time, the cars that we drove, and the cultural things going on in society at that time. You can read the comments [HERE](#).

Posts Regarding Life and Contentment

Here are some other similar posts on this venue. If you enjoyed this post, you might like these posts as well. These posts tend to discuss growing up in America. Often, I like to compare my life in America with the society within communist China. As there are some really stark differences between the two.



The Fiasco of the Reengineering of the Common Tomato

This is the sad, sad story about how the wonderful and tasty tomato was reengineered to be “better”. It was made better to ship. Better to sell. Better to store. However, there was one thing missing. No one paid any attention to taste, which is why it tastes like a cardboard shipping box today.



Mad Scientist Explorations

Here we discuss what it was like growing up as a boy in the 1960's and the 1970's and the people, things, and adventures that inspired us. As such, we explore how the independence of growing up enabled us to cope through life when we got older.



The Gorilla Cage in the Basement

When I was a small boy, I used to play in the abandoned buildings nearby. Here is a story about one of the objects that lay hidden inside one of those buildings and the possible mysteries that it held. As a child we thought it was a gorilla cage, now as an adult, I am not so sure...



The Importance of a Family Meal Together

There is nothing more important and satisfying than spending time together with friends and family and eating a meal together. It is a time of friendship, familial bonding and relaxation. Here we discuss what I have learned from my childhood and how I apply it today in my life.



The Pleasures of Fresh Baked Bread with Butter

One of the things that I have come to miss, since I moved to China, is fresh hard crusty rolls with full salted butter. The Chinese are not really fans of crusty bread. They like sweets and sponge cakes. Here I describe something that is close to me; not appreciating what you have right in front of you.



What Work was Like in the 1960's and 1970's.

When people go to work today, they find that there are all kinds of rules and regulations. It is for diversity, safety, inclusion, and improvement in a new progressive world. Well, here is what work was like before it became a sterile progressive testing ground for the New World Order.



Learning during my 1970s High School years

Here is a pretty long post on what it was like to go to elementary school in the 1960's, and then attend high school in the 1970's. I graduated in 1977, and that my friend is exactly the target date for the famous movie "Dazed and Confused". Here is the real deal what it was like.



Some True Stories of Cat Heaven

Being in MAJestic taught me many things. One of which was an intimate understanding of Heaven and other "spiritual" things relative to quanta entanglements. Here I discuss what it is like to have a beloved animal (cat) dies and what actually happens to them and why.



Life Lessons from Working within the Corporate Dream – 1

After I was trained by MAJestic, I was left to fend for myself in Corporate America. It was a hellish existence. As such, I learned many lessons concerning behavior and the ultimate impact that it holds on our families, our friends, our loved ones, and our very lives. Here are my commentaries.



Life Lessons from Working within the Corporate Dream – 2

This is part two of the two part section. There is quite a lot of information to impart. Stories are told, and experiences relayed. Honestly working in corporate America in the 1980's, through the new century really sucked. It was harsh on everyone except the owners of the companies.



How to Build Up Your Life from Nothing.

This is for all those young men who are just leaving school and trying hard to build up their life. You can do it. Here are my thoughts and advice for a young man who is encountering that most difficult of challenges; carving your life out in the wilds of the world.



Allow your Children to Play and Grow (Part 1)

I am horrified, just horrified, that parents do not allow their children to play, roam and explore on their own. It has created a society of pampered fearful children. Here I discuss this in terms of what I know. This is very non-PC and might offend the more liberal readers out there.



Allow your Children to Play and Grow (Part 2)

This is the second part of my rant about permitting children to play, explore and have fun. Everyone, the odds that some stranger will abduct your child is very small. Most people who do this are family friends and neighbors. Stop being so fearful. It harms the development of your child.



Ode to Diabolical Cretin John McCain

Well, that evil son-of-a-bitch is finally dead. If his grave wasn't so far away, I go there and dance on top of it. This guy has spent his life backstabbing people, hurting people, concocting wars, and doing everything in his power to disrupt the lives of people. Good fucking riddance.



The Song "Baby Got Back" Translated into Latin

Here is a fun post. The song "Baby Got Back" is translated into Latin and then back again. I have to tell you that it is indeed hilarious. *Rebecca, ecce! tantae clunes isti sunt!* (Rebecca, behold! Such large buttocks she has!) Anyways, it's just all fun and games. Enjoy.

More Posts about Life

I have broken apart some other posts. They can best be classified about ones actions as they contribute to happiness and life. They are a *little different*, in subtle ways.



On Being an Older Gent

Here are my thoughts on growing old as a man. The truth is that the life that I expected to have as I was growing up never materialized. Instead, something else manifested. My life today is nothing compared to what I thought it would be. For my illusions were created by American media.



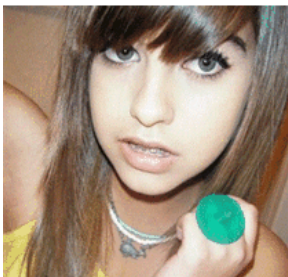
Calexit and the American Civil War

This is a pretty detailed look at the causes of the American civil war, and why it wasn't about slavery. We look at the rewriting of history by the internet, and the efforts that President Obama took to keep California intact so that the Democrats could maintain political power and control.



Why an American man should leave America and Travel

All people should get up off their duff and go forth and Travel. However, this is most especially true for American men. The United States has become a crucible of PC progressive realities that attack and depreciate American men. Go out, young man, see the world as it really is!



The Amazing Bremelanotide PT-141

Forget Viagra, and all those other ED medications. This is the real deal. This little baby causes humans to *go into heat*. It interacts with the brain and sets up feelings of intense arousal on both men and women. It turns people into 16 year olds. As such it is banned in the USA by the FDA.



Bronco Billy and the 25th Law of Power

Bronco Billy is a fictional movie starring Clint Eastwood. The movie depicts the life of a man who decides to change his life and go ahead and do what he has always dreamed of doing. He goes out and becomes his dream. There are lessons here for all of us, we only need listen.



The r/K Selection Theory applied to American Politics

The r/K theory is a pretty well-known theory on animal behavior. It simply states that animals behave as they need to based on the scarcity of resources. Here, we argue that it can be applied to why humans follow different political philosophies. Especially in American politics.



How they get away with it

Ten years ago, Bankers committed fraud in Wall Street that just about devastated the nation. Earlier, we had the S&L fiasco, the nightmare with penny stocks, and now the grand wholesale treason with the selling of Top Secrets to a foreign nation. This is how they get away with it.



The Line in the Sand – Now What?

It's the same story. Just vote for us, and we will correct everything. Yet, nothing ever happens. You know, boys and girls, this old "song and dance" can only be maintained for so long. Eventually it will fracture, and people will no longer rely on elections to institute change...



The importance of having a second passport.

So President Trump is building a wall to protect Americans. Hum. Where have I heard that before? Oh yes, in Germany right when they were making the wall that separated Berlin. Walls serve two purposes; they keep people out, but they also keep people in. Be careful what you wish for.



How Rocket Scientists Build Paper Airplanes

This is a tale of what me and my classmates used to do when we were young Aerospace Engineering students at the university. We would design paper airplanes and shoot them down with bottle rockets. Here is just a fun little exercise down "memory lane". Enjoy.



What is Snopes.com and can it be Trusted?

Snopes is a "fact check" website that is fully funded by the oligarchy. It is used to "shout down" any narratives that does not support the rich and powerful, and politically connected globally. Here we discuss the organization, who they are and what they represent.



Today America Taxes it's Expats without Representation.

This is a sad state of affairs. Americans who reside outside of the United States now have to pay American taxes, even though they have no representation in Congress. As I recall this was one of the reasons for the American cry for independence in 1776.



What life is like inside the ADC Prison in Arkansas

This post discusses what life is like in a hard labor prison in Southern Arkansas. We discuss hoe squads, food, the hole, commissary, dress, fashion, homosexual culture, prison gangs, murders, relationships and other aspects of life when you are sentenced to "Hard Time".



The Hazing of New Employees – A Lost Tradition

Up until the 1980's all companies would haze new employees. Today, we live in a world regulated by the government and policed by Human Resources. We forget how things used to be just a handful of decades ago. Here is my narrative when I started to work.



How to Build a Gallows and a Hangman's Noose

The United States is entering a period of strife. There will be violence. There will be discord and discomfort. It will be an ugly time. There will be winners and losers. It will be painful for the losers, and the victor will need build a gallows. This is how to do so and why it is needed.



The Ultimate Method to Make Your Computer Safe and Secure

The best way to make your computer secure and private is to have very strong encryption and use an obscure operating system that very few people know about. Here we look at 37 obscure computer operating systems.

Stories that Inspired Me

Here are reprints in full text of stories that inspired me, but that are nearly impossible to find in China. I place them here as sort of a personal library that I can use for inspiration. The reader is welcome to come and enjoy a read or two as well.



Robert Heinlein's "The Long Watch" – Full Text

What if you were in charge of all the nuclear weapons in the world, and your base Commander checks your political leanings to see if you are willing to conduct a coup d'état. What would you do? Would you go along with the opportunity, or would you be a lone hero?



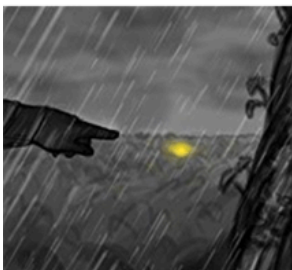
Kaleidoscope (Full Text) A Story by Ray Bradbury

This is the full text of a short story by Ray Bradbury. It concerns the final moments of a crew of spacemen as they drift about in space helplessly after their space rocket explodes. They know that no one can help them as they await their final moments tumbling through space...



Here There Be Tygers by Ray Bradberry

When I was younger I used to read science fiction stories for pleasure. They filled my minds with adventure and passion. One of my favorite authors was Ray Bradberry and here is a complete reprint of one of the stories that has influenced me to be the man that I am today. Enjoy.



The Long Rain (Full Text) by Ray Bradberry

This is the full text of a most excellent science fiction story. It concerns a group of survivors from a crashed spaceship stranded on a Hellish rainy planet; the tropical cloud-covered Venus. They survive the crash, but have to battle the forces of nature and their own passions.



The Fog Horn (Full Text) by Ray Bradberry

Here is a story about the emotions of being the last of your kind. This story is one that influenced me when I was a young boy in the 1970's and continues to haunt me to this day. All of us are human. We all feel emotions and passions. They drive us to accomplish or destroy. It's our choice.



The Rocket (Full Text) A Story by Ray Bradbury

This is a nice short story about a poor man who dreamed about flying into space. No matter how hard he worked, and no matter how much he saved, he was never able to provide for that dream. Then one day, when he was asked to scrap a test rocket, a thought came to mind...



Dark They Were and Golden Eyed (Full Text) by Ray Bradbury

This is the complete short story by Ray Bradbury. It is a story about change and adaptation. I first read this story in my teens and it influenced me to live the life that I am currently living. It is a great read.



A Sound of Thunder (Full Text) A Story by Ray Bradbury

This is the full text of the great time-travel story by Ray Bradbury. Here, a time-travel machine is used to send people back in time to shoot a dinosaur. However, something goes wrong. What would you do? It's a classic story and well worth a read again.

Articles & Links

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Notes

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